ZHILIANG LIN 林志良

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Health Behavior, Mental Health, Longitudinal Data Analysis, Health Communication

EDUCATION

Ghent University, Ghent, Belgium *Expected 2027*
M.Sc. in Statistical Data Analysis (Advanced Master's Program)

Jinan University, Guangzhou, China *2019*
M.A. in Communication

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics, Chengdu, China *2015*
B.A. in Journalism (Financial Journalism)

RESEARCH PROJECTS

- **M.Sc. thesis**: Bidirectional associations between body mass index and depression in the Belgian BELHEALTH cohort (data provided by Sciensano). Five survey waves over 66 months; linear mixed models, latent class growth analysis and spline models on 12,803 adults with repeated measures. Found an asymmetric bidirectional relationship (BMI → depression stronger than the reverse), a U-shaped association between BMI and depressive symptoms, and a coupling that stayed stable across the pandemic-to-post-pandemic transition.
- **Zhiliang Lin**. From Health Consciousness to Connected Action: Online Information Seeking and Social Support as Serial Mediators of Healthy Behaviors among Chinese College Students. Extended abstract accepted at the *IAMCR 2026 Annual Conference* (not presented); revised full paper in preparation.

PUBLICATIONS

- Guangchao Charles Feng, **Zhiliang Lin**, Xianglin Su, & Wanhua Ou. (2021). A Model-based Meta-analysis of Willingness to Participate in Cancer Screening. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health, 18* (5), 2580. (**Q1 SSCI journal in public health**) [link]
- Guangchao Charles Feng, Xianglin Su, **Zhiliang Lin**, Yiru He, Nan Luo, & Yuting Zhang. (2021). Determinants of Technology Acceptance: Two Modeling-based Meta-analytic Reviews. *Journalism & Mass Communication Quarterly, 98* (1), 83-104. (**Q1 SSCI journal in communication**) [link]
- Guangchao Charles Feng, Yuting Zhang, & **Zhiliang Lin**. (2019). A Meta-Analysis of the Effects of Sociodemographic Factors on Social Media Adoption. *International Journal of Communication, 13*, 1996-2025. (**Q3 SSCI journal in communication**) [link]
- (*in Chinese*) **Zhiliang Lin**. (2019). Your Friends Matter: A Mediation Model of Wechat Use and School Identity. *New Media Research, 06*, 17-22. [link]

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- (*in Chinese*) **Zhiliang Lin**. (2025, Jan) An Online Survey of the Public's Character Preference towards *The Story of the Stone*. *The 9th Academic Seminar of the School of Literature and Media, Guangzhou Nanfang College*, Guangzhou, China. [link][code]
- Nan Luo, Yiru He, & **Zhiliang Lin***. (2020, Aug) Doing Data-driven Research Using the IMDb Dataset. *ICA Pre-conference on Open Methods, Open Data*, Virtual Conference.
- Yiru He, Nan Luo, & **Zhiliang Lin***. (2020, May) "Three Layers, Two Types of Domestic News Flow": News Prominence of Places in Chinese Newspapers. *International Cultures of Journalism Conference*, Sydney, Australia.
- Xianglin Su, **Zhiliang Lin**, Yuting Zhang, & Guangchao Charles Feng. (2019, May) Determinants of Technology Acceptance: Two Modeling-based Meta-analytic Reviews. *69th Annual ICA Conference*, Washington, D.C., USA.
- Wanhua Ou, **Zhiliang Lin**, Xianglin Su, & Guangchao Charles Feng. (2018, Aug). Engagement in Cancer Screening: Theoretical Exploration Using A Meta-Analytical Structural Equation Modeling Approach. *AEJMC 2018 Annual Conference*, Washington, D.C., USA.
- **Zhiliang Lin**, Yuting Zhang, & Guangchao Charles Feng. (2018, May). The Effects of Socio-demographic Factors on the Social Media Divide: A Meta-analytic Review. *68th Annual ICA Conference*, Prague, Czech Republic.
- (*in Chinese*) **Zhiliang Lin** & Jiahong Wu. (2017, Apr). Marxism in Chinese Journalism and Communication Studies: A Bibliometric Overview. *Red Heritage: Marxism and Chinese Journalism and Communication Consortium*, Chongqing, China.

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Guangzhou Nanfang College Jul 2020 - Sep 2025
Teaching Associate

Shenzhen University Jul 2019 - Jun 2020
Research Associate

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

While working at Guangzhou Nanfang College, I taught the following courses:

- Statistics for Communication Studies [link]
- New Media Data Analysis [link]
- Web Data Scraping [link]
- Academic Writing
- Mass Communication Research Methods

WORKSHOPS ATTENDED

Artificial Society and Computational Social Science *Jul 2017; Aug 2023*
Sun Yat-Sen University

Leadership Meta Essentials *Sep 2020*
Netherlands Psychological Statistics Union

The Application of Bayesian Statistical Methods in Management *Jun 2017*
Sun Yat-Sen University

SELECTED AWARDS & HONORS

Guoqiang Scholarship for Media Students (CNY 1000) *2019*

Jinan University Graduate Academic Scholarship, Second Prize (CNY 6000) *2018*

Jinan University Grant for International Academic Conferences (CNY 15000) *2018*

Jinan University Graduate Academic Scholarship, Third Prize (CNY 2000) *2017*

Jinan University Graduate Academic Scholarship, Second Prize (CNY 6000) *2016*

Southwestern University of Finance and Economics Academic Scholarship, Third Class (CNY 600) *2015*

SKILLS

Statistical Methods	Linear mixed models, latent class growth analysis, (PLS-)SEM, meta-analysis
Programming Languages	R (lme4, lcmm, mice), Python, SQL
Statistics Software	SPSS, AMOS, SmartPLS
Other Tools	CiteSpace, Ucinet, Tableau, Zotero

LANGUAGES

Mandarin Chinese (Native), Cantonese (Native), English (Fluent, IELTS 7.0)